

CS 201 Graph Algorithms

Week 9: Graph Traversal & Shortest Paths

1. Graph Representations

- Adjacency list vs adjacency matrix
- Directed vs undirected graphs

2. Breadth-First Search (BFS)

- Uses a queue, explores level by level
- Finds shortest path in unweighted graphs

3. Depth-First Search (DFS)

- Uses a stack (or recursion)
- Useful for cycle detection, topological sort

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4. Dijkstra's Algorithm

- Greedy approach, uses a priority queue
- Works only with non-negative edge weights

5. Bellman-Ford Algorithm

- Handles negative edge weights
- $O(V \cdot E)$ time complexity

6. Complexity Comparison

- BFS/DFS: $O(V + E)$
- Dijkstra: $O((V + E) \log V)$ with a heap
- Bellman-Ford: $O(V \cdot E)$